

Title: Bot lane wave management: I only know 2 real strategies. What am I missing?

Score:

--- POST CONTENT ---

I am currently a gold ADC and I want to learn more about wave management bot lane. The problem is, I'm not sure what I don't know so I can't really search for it on YouTube. The only 2 wave control strategies I use in lane are:

- 1) push as fast as possible if I need to recall or my opponents recall/die/leave lane
- 2) if I'm way stronger than my lane opponents then I try to not let them touch the wave and keep it close to my turret by only last hitting.

What else can I add to my game to make my lane better? I play Jhin and MF if that matters.

--- TOP COMMENTS ---

[Comment 1 | Score: 48]

There are many guides out there so I won't spend too much time here, but:

1. Slow-push: get control of the wave by hitting level 2 first, then use level 2 to zone enemy off the wave. Then ONLY last hit and stack the wave. Incoming wave will reinforce current wave. Stack 3 waves, then crash (3rd wave is cannon) by fast pushing. This leaves you with a buy or a dive. While you are slow-pushing, you can usually play aggressively because you have a minion advantage and exp advantage. This is a longstanding strategy called the 3-wave crash. In order to slow-push, you have either have a minion advantage or force prio by getting a level advantage.
2. Bounce-back slow-push (bouncing): When the wave crashes into enemy tower, and the enemy minions start attacking the wave under tower, the wave will bounce back and slow-push right back to

you. During this time, it is better to be defensive and wait for the wave to come in. Given you are gold, this won't happen often as players just mindlessly attack the wave, but knowing the time to be aggressive and defensive is important.

3. Resetting the wave: This is when you just push the wave and crash it, but the wave dies before enemy incoming wave gets to your wave. Wave will be reset and meet in the middle.

4. Freezing: all you need is for the enemy wave to have 3-4 minions (4 for a clean freeze, 3 takes a little more skill to make it work) MORE than your wave. As the wave is coming in, if you don't have a wave, you'll have to "pull" the wave near bottom brush and tank minions until your wave comes then freeze it just outside of your turret. Now all you do is last hit and the enemy minions will kill your minions thus denying exp and gold to your lane opponent. When to use this? When the enemy takes a bad recall (recalls with the wave slow-pushing away from them), enemy rotates to dragon and you can't because they are either stronger than you or you have a wave in front of your turret. You can opt to freeze instead of fast push if enemy has a bigger wave. This will deny them xp and gold. You can also use this when you are SIGNIFICANTLY stronger than your enemy. They took a bad fight, you won, you are snowballing, they want to cs, but you won't let them. Ideally you'll hold the freeze and support will zone the enemy off of xp.

1. Freeze will turn into a slow-push again, so slow push it back, crash it, and again you'll have the same options of resetting or diving.

5. Fast-Push: In lower elos you will mostly be doing this to press your advantage. This just means you hard push the wave, usually leading to a wave reset. Do this when you have prio for dragon (or to create prio) and need to go to dragon, do this if you have strong push and the enemy is stronger than you so you can't fight (think Sivir vs Draven. Sivir just wants to push waves and scale so she just fast pushes EVERY wave after level 5 and can just become non-interactive with the enemy). You can also do this if you need to reset and don't have a good timer. Keep in mind that in higher elos, players are good enough to force trades on you when you're fast-pushing every wave (ie: Sivir tries to fast push wave, Draven runs at her forcing an all-in).

These are the basics so I'll just leave it at that.

[Comment 2 | Score: 14]

Slow push is critical to playing the game in general and it's what allows you to pressure and get leads in the first place. It's like your #2 but when your wave is bigger than theirs. It lets you trade with minion advantage or poke for free when they try to get farm. It also is what causes there to be large minion waves stacked. These bigger minion crashes give you opportunities to roam, recall, take plates, dive or poke under turret. You are somewhat gankable because you're pushing but with a bigger wave it's very possible to 2v3 by fighting in it.

[Comment 3 | Score: 3]

Honestly, just read through this.

[\[https://mobalytics.gg/blog/wave-management/\]](https://mobalytics.gg/blog/wave-management/)(<https://mobalytics.gg/blog/wave-management/>)

It has all the basics and includes video examples to help give you an idea what these concepts look like when applied to an actual game.

Edit: If you use this, ignore the information about leashing. That shit is outdated as fuck and you should basically never leash. Guard jungle entrances at game start but don't stick around to leash. It's a waste of your time.

[Comment 4 | Score: 2]

For your first point that's not always true. Let's say you kill them, the wave is on your side, and you are low on mana. Sometimes the best thing to do is just immediately recall and drop some CS so you don't lose even more with a bad timer. Especially as Jhin / MF who have pretty poor wave

clear.

For the second, that's really bad generally. It depends on the match up but freezing when stronger is typically bad. Your jungler can't do dragon, you can't get plates, and can be harder to pressure them. Also in the event you kill them it can often put you in a situation like in the last paragraph meaning you don't benefit as much from a kill. It also locks your support in lane which matters more as you get higher elo. Usually it's better to slow push a wave in the neutral state, crash a big wave, farm 1/2 to a full plate, then do it again when the wave resets neutral.

I searched for two seconds and already found [https://youtu.be/ZhEdNM-rYeY?si=c8G2MIhukZU0FFn_]. There are plenty of guides available and wave management is way to complicated to lay out everything here.

[Comment 5 | Score: -2]

Slowpush

Proxy